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9. Follow the 1-2-3 process

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Rather than blasting out all applications at one time, send out 1, then 2, then 3 applications; it will give you time to reflect on the process, rethink your essay, and make adjustments.

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10. Keep trying

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Don't stop after you have won your first scholarship. Your credentials are now validated and looked on more favorably by subsequent scholarship committees. (Some scholarships, though, may be reserved for those who have not yet won awards.)

Kimberly also gave a little advice on what judges look for. Primarily, they look for differentiation. Consider and explain how you are different from your peers. Though you may have a similar academic record as another applicant, you may have a vastly different personal life and may have faced unique challenges. They are also looking at your writing skills. There's a reason an essay is usually involved.

A \$500 award that may seem small now could double in value if used to offset student loans (based on 8% interest rate—though rates vary depending on the year—capitalization of interest while earning your degree, and 10-year loan payback).

After you have begun college, you can pursue new scholarships, scholarship renewals, and scholarships pertaining to specific majors. But remember to make good grades so you can keep any scholarships that are dependent on maintaining a certain GPA. — **Julie Rains**

10 Ways to Eat for Free in College

Eating seems to be a major expense for college students not on some sort of meal plan. How will you survive the next few weeks until you go home to Mom and Dad with a car full of laundry and a scheme to get them to help you out until the end of the semester? Here are a few tricks of the trade I learned. Take notes, my students, and swallow your pride.

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1. Professors

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Make friends with your professors and get invited over for dinner. My friend Jennifer and I survived countless poor Friday nights by getting invited over for dinner. We stuck